

Day 1 — Identifying & Mapping Key Stakeholders

Activity packet for participant triads. Today's job: take the TCD §6 sign-off matrix, expand it into a real stakeholder map (Power × Interest + RACI), and draft SEP §1.

Where we are in the week

The TCD already has §6 — a sign-off matrix listing constraints and owners. That matrix is the **starting input** to today's work. Today expands it into a usable map: who has what kind of power, who cares how much, who is Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, or Informed.

By 16:00, every triad has SEP §1 — a stakeholder map ready to drive engagement planning tomorrow.

Inputs

- TCD §6 (stakeholder sign-off matrix from Week 4 Day 5)
- PRD §10 (named dependencies + owners)
- The triad's customer interviews (Week 1) for stakeholder context

Why "stakeholder mapping" is not org-chart copying

A common rookie mistake: list the team names from the org chart and call it a stakeholder map. That's not a map — it's a directory.

A real stakeholder map answers:

- **Who has the power to block this work?**
- **Who cares whether it ships?**
- **Whose buy-in do we *need*?** (vs whose buy-in is *nice-to-have*?)
- **Who must be consulted vs only informed?**
- **Who do we wish we could ignore but can't?**

Org charts answer "who reports to whom." Maps answer "whose attention do we need to manage and how?"

The Power × Interest Grid (today's first frame)

A 2x2 placing every stakeholder by:

- **Power:** how much can they affect this work? (block it, fund it, redirect it, accelerate it)
- **Interest:** how much do they care about this work?



Each quadrant suggests an engagement style:

QUADRANT	ENGAGEMENT STYLE
High power, high interest	Manage closely — frequent, deep engagement
High power, low interest	Manage with authority — keep them out of weeds; surface only when needed
Low power, high interest	Keep informed — engaged audience; you'll learn from them
Low power, low interest	Monitor — low effort; check in periodically

Most TPMs over-invest in the high-interest quadrants and under-invest in the **high-power-low-interest** quadrant. That's the quadrant that surprises you with a "no" at the worst time.

The RACI assignment (today's second frame)

Once stakeholders are placed on the grid, assign their role for **specific decisions** in the project:

LETTER	ROLE	DEFINITION
R	Responsible	Does the work. There can be many R's.
A	Accountable	Owens the outcome. Exactly one person per decision.
C	Consulted	Two-way conversation; opinion sought.
I	Informed	One-way notification; outcome shared.

The discipline: **one A per decision**. If two people are A, neither is. If no one is A, the decision will rot.

For a single feature, several decisions need RACI:

- The **scope** of the feature
- The **architecture** (TCD §1 stance)
- The **SLO targets**
- The **launch date**
- Each **out-of-scope follow-up** (deferred to a backlog with an owner)

Activity 1 — Build the Stakeholder List

Format: Triad • 35 min • Block 1

Purpose

Build a **complete** stakeholder list before mapping. Most triads will start with 5–7 stakeholders and discover they have 12–15.

Triad protocol

1. **Start with TCD §6** (5 min). Copy every stakeholder name from the sign-off matrix into a list.
2. **Augment with the "five circles"** (15 min). For each circle, add anyone who isn't already on the list:
 - **Customer-facing**: customer success, sales, support
 - **Engineering-adjacent**: architecture, security, platform, infra, data, QA
 - **Operating partners**: ops, IT, compliance, legal, finance
 - **Decision-makers**: PM lead, eng director, GM, executive sponsor
 - **Indirect interest**: other product teams whose work this touches
3. **Cull lightly** (5 min). Anyone who genuinely doesn't need to be on the list, drop. Default: keep.
4. **Capture context per stakeholder** (10 min). For each, one sentence:
 - What's their role on this feature?
 - What do they care about most?

Output

A **comprehensive stakeholder list** (typically 10–18 names) with role + concern.

Activity 2 — Power x Interest Mapping

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 2

Purpose

Place each stakeholder on the 2x2 grid. The discussion of *where* each one goes is most of the learning.

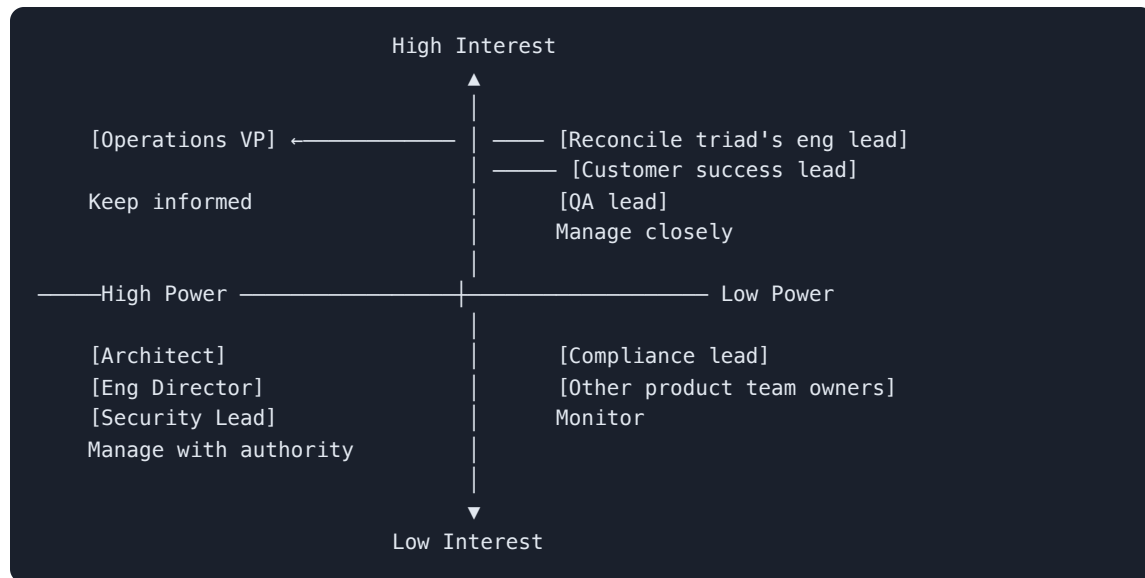
Triad protocol

1. **Sketch the 2x2** on whiteboard or paper (5 min).
2. **Place each stakeholder with a sticky note** (15 min). Argue when you disagree — don't average.
3. **Highlight the four corners** (10 min). For each quadrant:
 - Who is here?
 - What does our engagement style with them need to look like?
4. **Identify the 2 "surprises"** (10 min). Usually:
 - One person you thought was high-power who actually isn't (their veto isn't real)
 - One person you thought was low-interest who actually isn't (they care more than they let on)

What "good" looks like

- **All four quadrants populated** (if your "low power / low interest" is empty, you've over-prioritized)
- **Discussion happened** — triads converged on placements through argument, not by the loudest voice
- **Engagement style** is named per quadrant
- **The two surprises** are flagged — these are your high-leverage discoveries

Worked example — FieldPulse reconcile



The "surprise" for FieldPulse: **Compliance** is low-interest in the abstract but **high-power in specific moments** (audit deadlines). Its position can shift; flag it.

Activity 3 — RACI Assignment for Five Decisions

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 3

Purpose

Assign RACI to the five most consequential decisions for the feature.

The five decisions

For most features:

1. **Scope** — what's in vs out
2. **Architecture** — TCD §1 stance + key trade-offs
3. **SLO targets** — TCD §4
4. **Launch date** — when it ships
5. **Out-of-scope follow-up backlog** — deferred items + owners

The matrix template

Decision	R	A	C	I
Scope	TPM (you)	PM Director	Eng Lead, Architect, Customer Success	Sales, Support
Architecture	Architect	Eng Director	TPM, Security, Platform	All eng
SLO targets	Eng Lead	TPM	SREs, Customer Success	Eng Director
Launch date	TPM	PM Director	Eng Lead, Customer Success, Marketing	All eng, Sales
OOS backlog ownership	TPM	TPM	Eng Lead	Backlog readers

Triad protocol

1. **Draft the matrix** (20 min). One A per decision. Multiple R/C/I OK.
2. **The "no two A's" check** (5 min). Walk the columns; verify exactly one A per decision.
3. **The "is the A actually empowered?"** (10 min). For each A, check: do they have the authority (formal + informal) to make the call? If not, reassign.
4. **The "anyone surprised by being I?"** (5 min). Often a stakeholder gets I when they think they're C. Surface that and decide.

Activity 4 — SEP §1 Polish + Stakeholder Watch List

Format: Triad • 45 min + Wrap • Block 4

Purpose

Polish §1 of the SEP, plus identify a **watch list** of stakeholders whose status could change in the next month.

The watch list

For each stakeholder in the **high-power-low-interest** quadrant, ask:

- What event would move them to **high-interest**?
- What's our trigger to escalate engagement?

Examples:

- **CFO** — currently low-interest. Would move to high-interest if quarterly cost forecasts change. Trigger: cost projection > \$X.
- **General Counsel** — currently low-interest. Would move to high-interest if a regulator inquires. Trigger: any regulator email.
- **Chief Customer Officer** — currently low-interest. Would move to high-interest if a top-10 account complains. Trigger: top-10 escalation.

A watch list is the early-warning system. It's the section that distinguishes a TPM who manages stakeholders from one who reacts to them.

Triad protocol

1. **Polish §1** (15 min). Combine list + PowerxInterest grid + RACI into one section. Add the "two surprises" callouts.
2. **Build the watch list** (20 min). 3–5 stakeholders with their triggers.
3. **Cross-check against the TCD §6 sign-off matrix** (5 min). Anyone in §1 not on §6? Add to §6. Anyone on §6 not in §1? Add to §1.
4. **AI cross-check** (5 min). Run the prompt below.

AI prompt

Role: Senior PM coaching a junior TPM on stakeholder management.
Context: <paste the stakeholder list with quadrants and RACI>
Task: Identify 3 likely blind spots:
1. A stakeholder who probably has more power than the map shows
2. A decision where the A is wrong or absent
3. A high-power-low-interest stakeholder whose trigger isn't named
Constraints:
- Be specific to the names and roles given
- Do not invent stakeholders
Format: 3 numbered findings, each with a one-sentence rationale.

Wrap (last 15 min)

Each triad shares:

- One stakeholder whose quadrant placement was the most contested
- One RACI-A that was reassigned during discussion
- One trigger from the watch list

End-of-day checkpoint

Each triad ends Day 1 with:

- ✓ Comprehensive stakeholder list with role + concern
- ✓ **Power x Interest grid** populated
- ✓ **RACI matrix** for 5 decisions, with one A per decision
- ✓ **Watch list** of high-power-low-interest stakeholders + triggers
- ✓ AI provenance log entry
- ✓ SEP §1 drafted